

Options for the Development of National Standards and Guidelines for Animal Welfare

AWTG 24-02 noted an update from the secretariat that targeted stakeholder engagement to discuss the draft standards development framework will now commence.

Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Livestock at Processing Facilities and Establishments

AWTG 24-02 noted an update from Queensland that the review of stakeholder feedback of the draft standards is almost complete. Preparation for public consultation is underway. Work has commenced on procuring a consultant for regulation impact analysis.

Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Land Transport of Livestock - horses

AWTG 24-02 noted that the proposed amendments to the Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Land Transport of Livestock to improve the welfare of horses will be presented for endorsement to agricultural senior officials at the upcoming meeting in June. The amendments will then be brought to agriculture ministers for final endorsement.

Virtual Fencing Technology

AWTG 24-02 noted an update from the Commonwealth that an independent facilitator for the virtual fencing stakeholder reference group has been engaged. Meetings will commence shortly.

Renewed Australian Animal Welfare Strategy (AAWS)

AWTG 24-02 noted an update from the Commonwealth that all ministers have agreed to a joint leadership approach to renew AAWS and to develop a national statement on animal welfare. Broad stakeholder consultation on the AAWS has commenced, with a Have Your Say and submissions process open, and further avenues for engagement planned.

Further Information

If you would like further information on current AWTG projects or to engage with the AWTG on projects from the work plan, please contact the secretariat: awtg@aff.gov.au

Post: AWTG c/- Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry,
GPO Box 858, Canberra ACT 2601, Australia

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/animal/welfare/awtg/communique-april-2024>